

Disney

Pocahontas



Lyrics & Notes — Disney Hits · Pocahontas Collection



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Intro

Welcome to the Disney Hits — Pocahontas Collection. This fan-made lyric booklet invites you to read the songs like scenes: the river's pull of curiosity, the heartbeat of community, the pomp of conquest, and the courage to listen. Each number is set across a spread—lyrics on the left for flow and phrasing; brief notes on the right to spotlight themes, instrumentation, and story beats. The aim is clarity and empathy on paper: typography that breathes, motifs that echo nature's voice, and a format made to be handled, annotated, kept. All commentary and side notes are freely invented for educational/portfolio purposes and are unofficial.

Music: Alan Menken · Lyrics: Stephen Schwartz · © Disney
(original work). Part of my passion project Disney Hits.



The Virginia Company

In sixteen hundred seven
We sail the open sea
For glory, God, and gold
And The Virginia Company

For the New World is like
heaven
And we'll all be rich and free
Or so we have been told
By The Virginia Company
So we have been told
By The Virginia Company

For glory, God and gold
And The Virginia Company

On the beaches of Virginny
There's diamonds like debris
There's silver rivers flow
And gold you pick right off
a tree

With a nugget for my Winnie
And another one for me
And all the rest'll go
To The Virginia Company
It's glory, God and gold
And The Virginia Company



Opening the soundtrack from the English expedition's point of view, this number frames the voyage to Jamestown (1607) as enterprise and destiny. Menken writes it as a buoyant, march-like shanty: martial drums, bright brass, and a unison male chorus conjure deck work, rhythm, and cohesion at sea. Schwartz's lyrics celebrate profit, glory, and camaraderie while slipping in the risks ahead—bravado that masks uncertainty. The emphasis on “riches” and a “new world” foreshadows the greed and extraction that ignite later conflict, linking directly to the gold-obsessed rhetoric of “Mine, Mine, Mine.” Dramaturgically, it stands as a foil to the earth-rooted perspective of “Steady as the Beating Drum,” establishing the cultural and moral collision at the story's core. A subtle nautical motif (rope/compass) complements the page design.

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Performed by chorus of sailors/settlers · 1995.



Steady as the Beating Drum

Hega hega ya-hi-ye-hega
Ya-hi-ye-ne-he hega
Hega hega ya-hi-ye-hega
Ya-hi-ye-ne-he hega

Steady as the beating drum
Singing to the cedar flute
Seasons go and seasons come
Bring the corn and bear the fruit

By the waters sweet and clean
Where the mighty sturgeon lives
Plant the squash and reap the
bean
All the earth our mother gives

O Great Spirit, hear our song
Help us keep the ancient ways
Keep the sacred fire strong
Walk in balance all our days

Seasons go and seasons come
Steady as the beating drum
Plum to seed to bud to plum
(Hega hega ya-hi-ye hega)
Steady as the beating drum





Shifting to the Powhatan community's perspective, this number works as a prologue-in-miniature: a communal hymn to balance, reciprocity, and the rhythm of seasons. Menken grounds it in a steady frame-drum pulse—the village “heartbeat”—supporting a clear, folk-like melody colored by flute timbres and open, spacious harmonies. Schwartz's text catalogs daily work and ceremony without hierarchy; parallel phrases and simple verbs mirror collective action. Call-and-response entries and layered ostinati suggest many hands moving as one, while gentle modal inflections and pentatonic touches keep the line earth-rooted. Dramaturgically, it counterbalances the mercantile fervor of “The Virginia Company,” establishing the film's moral counterpoint and foreshadowing Pocahontas's river-and-wind leitmotifs. Design accent: a subtle woven pattern or river-pebble motif on the notes page to echo continuity and craft.

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Performed by chorus (Powhatan villagers) · 1995.



Just Around the Riverbend

What I love most about rivers is
You can't step in the same river twice

The water's always changing, always
flowing
But people, I guess, can't live like
that

We all must pay a price
To be safe, we lose our chance of
ever knowing

What's around the riverbend
Waiting just around the riverbend

I look once more, just around the
river bend
Beyond the shore, where the gulls
fly free

Don't know what for
What I dream the day might send
Just around the river bend for me
Coming for me

I feel it there beyond those trees
Or right behind these waterfalls
Can I ignore that sound of distant
drumming

For a handsome sturdy husband
Who builds handsome sturdy walls
And never dreams that something
might be coming?

Just around the river bend
Just around the river bend



Pocahontas's first solo channels kinetic curiosity into musical form. Menken writes a brisk, forward-leaning melody that rides restless rhythmic accents—strings and woodwinds dart like eddies—so the line feels as if it's tugged downstream. Subtle shifts of harmony and phrasing create “almost-cadences” that never fully settle, mirroring her unease with a prescribed path. Schwartz's lyrics stage a clear dramatic fork: safety and duty versus risk and discovery, with the river as living metaphor for time, choice, and identity. Call-and-response echoes of the community recede, leaving one voice navigating possibilities; the bridge opens the texture, then the final refrain surges with resolve. Dramaturgically, the number plants the film's adventure ethos and seeds the nature-listening motif that blossoms in “Colors of the Wind.”

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Vocals Judy Kuhn (Pocahontas) · 1995.



Listen With Your Heart

Ay ay ay ya
Ay ay ya

Que que na-to-ra, you will
understand

Listen with your heart, you
will understand
Let it break upon you, like a
wave upon the sand
Listen with your heart, you
will understand

You will understand

Ay ay ay ya
Ay ay ya

Que que na-to-ra, you will
understand

Listen with your heart, you
will understand
Let it break upon you like a
wave upon the sand
Listen with your heart, you
will understand





Serving as the film's spiritual compass, this cue functions more like a mantra than a conventional song. Menken shapes it as a gentle, rubato invocation: hand percussion and warm choral pads support a pentatonic melody that lingers on suspended harmonies, resolving only as Pocahontas reaches clarity. Schwartz's lyric distills counsel into a single imperative—perceive beyond fear and appearances. Heard twice (as I/II), the motif bridges turning points—the riverbank encounter and the closing choice—binding personal intuition to the voice of the land. Its purposeful simplicity (repetition = memory) makes the guidance portable across scenes and emotions, and it foreshadows the eco-empathy that blossoms fully in “Colors of the Wind.”

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Vocals Linda Hunt (Grandmother Willow), Judy Kuhn (Pocahontas), ensemble · 1995.



Mine, Mine, Mine

The gold of Cortés
The jewels of Pizarro
Will seem like mere trinkets
By this time tomorrow

The gold we find here
Will dwarf them by far
Oh, with all ya got in ya, boys
Dig up Virginia, boys

Mine, boys, mine ev'ry mountain
And dig, boys, dig ,til ya drop
Grab a pick, boys
Quick, boys
Shove in a shovel
Uncover those lovely
Pebbles that sparkle and shine
It's gold and it's mine, mine, mine

Dig and dig and dig and diggety
Dig and dig and dig and diggety

Hey nonny nonny, hiy nonny nonny
(Dig and dig and)

Oh, how I love it! (Dig and diggety)
Hey nonny nonny, hiy nonny nonny
(Dig and dig and)

Riches for cheap! (Dig and diggety)
Hey nonny nonny, hiy nonny nonny
(Dig and dig and)

There'll be heaps of it (Dig and
diggety)

And I'll be on top of the heap!
(Dig and dig and diggety-dig!)



A satirical showpiece of colonial greed, this number parades in with strutting dotted rhythms, parade snare, and gleaming brass—courtly pomp repurposed as mining anthem. Menken caricatures Ratcliffe with a heavy, narrow-ranged tune and pompous fanfares, while Schwartz packs patter lyrics and the possessive pun of “mine” into a catchy refrain. Midway, a clever contrapuntal passage pits Ratcliffe’s cramped motive against John Smith’s broader, open-interval line, staging an ideology clash in the music itself: extraction and titles vs. exploration and wonder. Pickaxe ostinati and choral shouts accelerate like an assembly line, visually and sonically foreshadowing the landscape’s wound and the militarized fervor that later explodes in “Savages.” Dramaturgically, it magnifies the profit rhetoric of “The Virginia Company,” turning aspiration into entitlement—with comedy that sharpens the critique.

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Vocals David Ogden Stiers (Governor Ratcliffe/Wiggins), Mel Gibson (John Smith) · 1995.



Colors of the Wind

You think I'm an ignorant savage
And you've been so many places
I guess it must be so
But still, I cannot see
If the savage one is me
How can there be so much that you don't know?
You don't know

You think you own whatever land you land on
The Earth is just a dead thing you can claim
But I know every rock and tree and creature
Has a life, has a spirit, has a name

You think the only people who are people
Are the people who look and think like you
But if you walk the footsteps of a stranger
You'll learn things you never knew you never
knew

Have you ever heard the wolf cry to the blue
corn moon?
Or asked the grinning bobcat why he grinned?
Can you sing with all the voices of the
mountain?
Can you paint with all the colors of the wind?
Can you paint with all the colors of the wind?

Come run the hidden pine trails of the forest
Come taste the sun-sweet berries of the Earth
Come roll in all the riches all around you
And for once, never wonder what they're worth

The rainstorm and the river are my brothers
The heron and the otter are my friends
And we are all connected to each other
In a circle, in a hoop that never ends

How high does the sycamore grow?
If you cut it down, then you'll never know

And you'll never hear the wolf cry to the blue
corn moon
For whether we are white or copper-skinned
We need to sing with all the voices of the
mountains
We need to paint with all the colors of the wind

You can own the Earth and still
All you'll own is earth until
You can paint with all the colors of the wind



The score's ethical center, this song reframes the story from conquest to kinship. Schwartz structures it as a gentle argument—rhetorical questions and vivid imagery (“mountain,” “river,” “wolf”) shift John Smith from owning nature to knowing it. Menken's broad, arching melody rides woodwind arabesques and soft percussion; subtle pentatonic coloring and harmonic sidesteps open the harmony like a horizon. Phrases breathe with rubato, then crest into the title refrain, whose wide intervals feel literally wind-borne. The lyric's core claim—“we are all connected”—binds the film's themes and echoes the counsel of “Listen With Your Heart,” turning personal intuition into ecological empathy. Dramaturgically, it's the conversion moment that makes every later choice legible.

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Vocals
Judy Kuhn (Pocahontas) · 1995.



Savages

What can you expect
From filthy little heathens?
Their whole disgusting race is like a curse
Their skin's a hellish red
They're only good when dead
They're vermin, as I said
And worse

They're savages! Savages!

Barely even human

Savages! Savages!

Drive them from our shore!
They're not like you and me
Which means they must be evil
We must sound the drums of war!

They're savages! Savages!
Dirty reddish devils!
Now we sound the drums of war!

This will be the day
(Spoken)
Let's go men

This will be the morning
(Spoken)
Bringing out the prisoner

We will see them dying in the dust

I don't know what I can do
Still I know I've got to try

Now we make them pay

Eagle help my feet to fly

Mountain help my heart be great

Now we leave 'em blood and bone and rust



Spirits of the Earth and Sky

It's them or us

Please don't let it be too late

They're just a bunch of filthy, stinking

Savages

Savages

Demons

Devils

Kill them

Savages

Savages

What are we waiting for?

Destroy their evil race until there's not a trace left

We will sound How
The drums of war Savages, Savages Loud are the
Now we sound Drums
The drums of war Savages, Savages Of war?

Now we see what comes Now we
Of trying to be chums Sound the
Of course it means the drums Drums Is the death of all I love
O.E.. O.E.. Carried in the drumming o.E..?

WAR!



The score's fulcrum of escalation, "Savages" turns fear into choreography. Menken drives a relentless war-march: pounding drums, minor-mode ostinati, and tight brass figures that lock the two camps into mechanized unison. Schwartz's text weaponizes repetition—the shouted epithet becomes a slogan, reducing people to a single word—and then splits into antiphonal lines that finally collide in canonic counterpoint. As both choruses layer simultaneously, the music exposes their mirrored rhetoric: identical rhythms, different targets. Harmonic crunches and rising sequences ratchet urgency while the orchestration shifts from earthy percussion to cutting brass and cymbals, sonically "arming" the scene. Dramaturgically, it's the brink: dehumanization reaches maximum volume so that the film's final acts—listening, restraint, and cross-cultural courage—can read as decisive defiance.

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz ·
Ensemble Colonists & Powhatan · 1995.



If I Never Knew You

If I never knew you
If I never felt this love
I would have no inkling of
How precious life can be

If I never held you
I would never have a clue
How at last I find in you
The missing part of me

In this world so full of fear
Full of rage and lies
I can see the truth so clear
In your eyes, so dry your eyes

And I'm so grateful to you
I'd have lived my whole life through
Lost forever
If I never knew you

I thought our love would be so beautiful
Somehow we'd make the whole world bright
I never knew that fear and hate could be so
strong

All they'd leave us were these whispers in the
night
But still my heart is saying we were right

If I never knew you (There's no moment I
regret)
If I never knew this love (Since the moment
that we met)
I would have no inkling of (If our time has
gone to past)
How precious life can be (I've lived at last)

And I'm so grateful to you
I'd have lived my whole life through
Empty as the sky

Never knowing why

Lost forever
If I never knew you



Set in the prison-cell night, this intimate duet weighs risk against the meaning found in meeting. Menken writes a gentle, rocking pulse with close strings and warm woodwinds; suspended harmonies delay resolution until the characters choose honesty. Call-and-response phrases gradually merge into shared lines, turning distance into accord. An uplifting bridge (subtle modulation, widened intervals) lets the melody “open,” matching the lyric’s shift from hypothetical loss to present gratitude. Schwartz’s conditional—“if I never knew you”—works as a thought experiment that clarifies value; imagery narrows from the world outside to two voices listening, echoing the score’s inner-compass theme from earlier cues. Dramaturgically, the song creates a still point before the climax, converting romance into moral resolve.

Credits: Music Alan Menken · Lyrics Stephen Schwartz · Vocals
Judy Kuhn (Pocahontas), Mel Gibson (John Smith) · 1995.





ART

Pocahontas's visual language blends lyrical naturalism with stylized geometry. Landscapes are treated like living tapestries: tall, vertical forests and cliff faces create calm, dignified silhouettes, while river curves and wind-swept diagonals carry motion across the frame. Color scripts lead emotion—earth ochres and pine greens for belonging; cool teals and violets for wonder and dusk; sharp metallics for invasion and industry. Motifs repeat quietly: leaf spirals, feather arcs, water ripples, and the compass rose—shapes you'll also find abstracted in this booklet's ornaments. Characters are simplified into clear, readable lines, letting hair, fabric, and gesture “catch the wind” as acting partners. Negative space is used deliberately, giving nature room to breathe and letting songs land like echoes in a vast valley. The result is a visual poem about place, balance, and choice.



Behind the Music

The score pairs Alan Menken's melodic storytelling with Stephen Schwartz's text that thinks in images. Together they build a musical map: river-bright woodwinds for curiosity, frame-drum pulses for community, burnished brass and snare for colonial pomp. Pentatonic colors and open intervals keep the "land's voice" spacious; march figures and narrow motives tighten whenever greed or fear take charge. Leitmotifs thread the film—wind and water shapes migrate between cues so that what Pocahontas hears in "Listen With Your Heart" can bloom fully in "Colors of the Wind." Choral writing functions as character, too: collective voices ground the village, while antiphonal layers in "Savages" expose mirrored rhetoric. Recorded with full orchestra and ensemble voices, the soundtrack moves from intimate, rubato counsel to kinetic, percussive urgency and back, always in service of the story's central question: Will we choose control, or connection?

CREDITS

Music — Alan Menken
Lyrics — Stephen Schwartz

Principal Vocals
Pocahontas — Judy Kuhn (singing)
John Smith — Mel Gibson
Governor Ratcliffe / Wiggins —
David Ogden Stiers
Grandmother Willow — Linda Hunt
Ensemble — Chorus

Score & Songs
Orchestra & Choir — [Name/Studio/
Ensemble]
Recording & Mixing — [Engineer],
[Studio]
Mastering — [Mastering Engineer],
[Facility]

Album Production — [Producer /
Music Supervisor]
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About the Creator

I'm Lana Schrattenecker, a communications & media design student who loves when music, words, and layout click into a single rhythm. I designed this booklet to practice editorial systems.

Pocahontas's soundtrack matters to me because it turns “nature” from backdrop into voice. This booklet is a small tribute to that idea: design that helps you listen with your eyes—to phrasing, breaths, and the spaces between lines. It's also a love letter to physical music objects: the kind you hold, annotate, and keep. Created for my passion project Disney Hits, this booklet forms part of the Pocahontas Collection.



Designed by Lana Schrattenecker — Editorial system,
typography, notes & prepress.
Part of the Disney Hits – Pocahontas Collection (passion
project).
All commentary and side notes are freely invented;
unofficial.

A decorative swirl of leaves and a feather, rendered in a simple line-art style with some areas filled in. The leaves are in shades of brown and tan, and the feather is a darker brown. The swirl starts at the top left, goes down, then up and around to the right, ending with a feather pointing towards the bottom right.

Lyrics & Notes — Disney Hits · Pocahontas Collection